DUNDALK INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
INSTITIÚID TEICNEOLAÍOCHTA DHÚN DEALGAN

Continuous Assessment
Cover Sheet

Student Name: Matthew Vickery	**Student Number:**

Programme: Computing in Games Development	**Stage: 2**	**Complete Student Checklist:** Re-read brief ☐ References and Bibliography ☐ Proofread ☐
Module: Applied Software Project Management		
Due Date:28/04/26	**No. Pages:3**	
Lecturer(s) Name: Frank Keenan		
Assignment No. and/or Description/Topic: **CA: Work Placement Preparation Project Management: Report**		**Mode of Submission:** Softcopy ☐ Hardcopy ☐

DECLARATION: **I declare that:**

- This work is entirely my own, and no part of it has been copied from any other person's words or ideas, except as specifically acknowledged through the use of inverted commas and in-text references;
- No part of this assignment has been written for me by any other person except where such collaboration has been authorised by the lecturer(s) concerned;
- I have not used generative artificial intelligence (AI) (e.g. ChatGPT) unless it has been permitted by the lecturer(s) concerned;
- I understand that I am bound by DkIT Academic Integrity Policy. I understand that I may be penalised if I have violated the policy in any way;
- This assignment has not been submitted for any other module at DkIT or any other institution, unless authorised by the relevant Lecturer(s);
- I have read and abided by all of the requirements set down for this assignment.

SIGNATURE.....Matthew Vickery.....
DATE.....28/04/26.....

Lecturer's Comments:

Provisional Mark : _____ **Lecturers Signature :** _____ **Date:** _____

Work submitted late will be subject to penalties in accordance with the DkIT Continuous Assessment Policy

Matthew Vickery D00190293 – Work Placement Preparation Report

Student Professional Profile:

Short professional summary

My name is Matthew Vickery, I am a student at Dundalk Institute of Technology and doing the course "BSc (Hons) in Computing in Games Development". I would like to explore a career in games development, with my overall all goal being to become either a lead director/ developer or a lead writer. I am a creative and hard working individual with skills in both writing and programming. I can be punctual for both arriving to work and for getting work done for projects on time, as I have worked on multiple project in college that had to get done within strict deadlines. I work well in both team and individual scenarios.

Key skills and technologies

- Teamwork: I am able to work alongside a team in order to achieve a certain goal or project. I have worked with many teams in the past to complete a project or goal, these include programming projects where we worked together on one GitHub repository to create a certain program, or working and coordinating on a GitHub repository in order to create a 3D animation, with each teammate having their own characters they had to create that interreacted with and reacted to each other teammates character.
- Independence: As well as working good in a team setting, I am also able to work well on my own in order to get a task done within a given timeframe.
- Creative: I can be quite a creative person when it comes to creating unique and interesting ideas, whether this is writing a story, making up with a fun and cool design, or drawing a creative piece of art.

- Timely: When needed I can get a piece of work done within a given deadline or show up to work on time.

Career interests

The career I am most interested in pursuing is that of Games development. This is because I have been interested in not only a creative endeavour for most of my life, but also interested in making video games. I have practiced making video games using the unreal engine on occasions in my free time.

Preferred placement focus areas

The places I would prefer getting placement in is either in the field of programming as I have some skills in that area, or better yet, a placement that will allow me to do writing as that is something I am deeply passionate about and have skills in, with me even currently writing a story and publishing it online chapter by chapter for around a year now and still going.

Curriculum Vitae (CV):

About Me

My name is Matthew Vickery. I am a very passionate individual who takes great joy from the things I create. I enjoy challenging myself in new and interesting ways to test the limit of what I can do. I have always wanted to create content to entertain people and bring them joy.

Education

- Leaving Cert 2011 - 2016
- Level 6 Higher Certificate in Science: Computing - Information Technology, TUDublin, 2017 – 2019
- Level 8- Computing in Games Development, DKIT, 2024 – 2028

Skills

- Independent: Able to work on my own.
- Teamwork: Able to work in a team to get a job done when needed. I have worked on and passed many group projects in college.
- Organisational skills: Very organized as I can organize all my equipment into a very orderly manner so I can then easily access them at a later time.
- Time management: Able to get a job done within the designated amount of time given
- I nitiative: Have the skills to be able to work on my own and figure out how to accomplish the task that is given to me

- A ttention to detail: Have a good eye for detail, and I am good at spotting patterns and how to organize things around them

Previous Jobs

General Labourer, Seating and Access Contracts Ltd.

- Worked alongside qualified scaffolders in the events industry
- Transported equipment and gear
- Helped to construct the structures
- Maintained and kept stock of equipment along with preparing it for the next job

Achievements

- Won multiple attendants awards while in school
- Through my organization and transportation of equipment I was able to save my co-workers time from having to constantly bring equipment to the structures.
- Through my management of equipment in the yard I was able to ensure that it could be easily found and loaded onto trucks for the next job. I also ensured a high standard of health and safety as I organized the equipment and reported any broken equipment to the management. I was able to use effective communication with my co-workers in order to get the project finished quicker and more efficiently.

Interests

- Models: I enjoy assembling and painting models and them displaying them nicely on my shelf or bringing them to casual tournaments to show off to others. I also enjoy changing up the models by either using bits from other kits of using clay to alter them in multitude of different ways
- Audio books: I enjoy listening to audio books while I paint my models, or while I am relaxing
- Reading: I enjoy picking up a nice book to read before going to sleep at night, taking my time to read each page.
- Gaming: For all my life I have enjoyed playing a wide variety of different games on a variety of platforms.
- Tournaments: I have gone to multiple Warhammer 40K casual tournaments over the past one to two years. Over the course of time I have slowly been getting better and better at both communicating with my opponent and getting better at the game as I went from constantly losing and being in lower positions to getting 6th place out of over twenty people in my last casual tournament.

Contact Details

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Github profile: MatthewVickery

Phone: 087 753 3086

Market Analysis Summary:

- Multinational: These are large companies that operate in two or more countries. They sometimes earn up to billions in profit.
- SME (Small and Medium-sized Enterprises): Companies that have "*fewer than 250 persons and which have an annual turnover not exceeding EUR 50 million, and/or an annual balance sheet total not exceeding EUR 43 million*" (Gov.ie, 2025)
- Start up: These are small and newly created companies, these usually have teams of less than twenty people and do not make as much money as the other two types of companies.

Reflection:

In my opinion the environment that bests suits me is a multinational company, this is for several reasons, though the most important reasons to me is:

- Easier to get into: Larger companies are more likely to have internship programs and more branches, meaning there is a far more likely chance for there to be a position open for me. A startup would be more tightly packed and so the developers might not have a need for an intern or maybe not even want to hire one as they might find it will take too much time away from their work, which they might see as to costly for how much they make. Or they might not even have the money or equipment to take on an intern.
- Networking: If I was to do well in such a company and have them as a reference then I result in me being more likely to get a good job position as the reference would hold more weight to it.
- Pay: Working with a larger company would have a higher chance of me being able to be paid for my internship work as they would have more money on hand.

Identification of Potential Work Placement Sites:

Riot:

- Location: The Observatory Building, 7-11 Sir John Rogerson's Quay
- What they do: Large multinational game development studio
- Games they work on: League of Legends, Valerant
- They have an internship program called the “Emerging talents program”. It is a paid internship program that provides interns with mentorship along with hosting a wide range of events for interns to attend, such as social and program events, they also provide interns with courses.
- Why I want to go: Riot Games is a large multinational gaming studio that appears to have a great internship program. This is both down the allay of want I want to do in the long run for my career, and I would be getting paid. Alongside this one of their Irish branches is easy for me to travel to as it only requires me to only take one bus and do less than a twenty-minute walk for me to get to there.

DIDGIT Games/ Scopely:

- Location: 4 Prince's St S, City Quay, Dublin 2
- What they do: Large multinational game development studio
- Games they work on: Monopoly Go, Pokémon Go, Stumble Guys
- Why I want to go: It is a large multinational gaming studio which means there is a chance to get paid for internship work, and like Riot Games they are in the field of work that I wish to pursue. Another reason I wish to go is just like how with Riot Games it is easy for me to travel there due to only needing one bus and doing less than a twenty-minute walk for me to get there as their building is just a short walk away from Riot Games.

IBM:

- Location: Blanchardstown
- What they do: Technological company
- Why I want to go: With it being a large multinational tech company there is a high chance for me to be paid. While not being gaming related it is still close to what I am studying due to the fact I am also learning software development. Another

reason is many students from DKIT were able to find internship at IBM, meaning if there is little chance of me getting an internship at another company then I might be able to get one at IBM, and it's always best to have a back-up plan.

Reflection on Readiness for Placement:

Current readiness:

Overall while I do think I am ready to start work experience, I think I have some ways to go in order to be able to obtain it, as I feel a nervous about whether or not I will be able to obtain an internship in the first place, or at a company I would like to work at/ easy for me to travel to. Once I know I have a position secured I should be fine from there.

Skills that still need developing:

One skill I know I'll need to improve upon is writing my CV and emailing companies asking about internships and how to obtain one with them. I know both skills are important for me to improve upon as both are needed to be able to get an internship from that company.

How the placement will support my professional growth:

I feel like work experience will assist my professional growth by teaching me more on how to be able to obtain a job as well as providing me with a good reference to use in order to assist me in getting a better job position than I would without it.

Another way it will help me is by showing me how to work within a professional environment. More importantly how to work within an IT or games development work environment as that is the type of work environment I am aiming to be a part of.

Ethical and professional responsibilities as a placement student:

One ethical and professional responsibility that would be needed to follow is to obey any NDA you are asked to sign. This can range from a new game or new content for a game being developed that had not been officially announced yet, or a tech company wanting to keep their internal workings a secret. Failure to do so could result in being fired or being sued.

Another responsibility is to follow the instructions given to you by the people who work there. This is because you are there to learn and not be disruptive/ cause problems at the workplace. If you were constantly doing what you were told not to do, then you might end up causing developmental problems that will cost the company money and time trying to fix your mistakes.

Another responsibility is to be respectful, they are hiring you on to teach you how things are in the workplace and how to improve your skills in their area of expertise. They are taking time out of their busy schedule to teach you, so being disrespectful would not be right. It would also result in you losing the opportunity to learn from them and you having a bad reputation in that industry and make finding a future job more difficult.

References:

- Gov.ie, 2025, Small Medium Enterprises (SMEs) [Online], Available from: https://www.gov.ie/en/office-of-government-procurement/publications/smes/ [Accessed 18th March 2026]